DEEPER LIFE CORPERS FELLOWSHIP PRODUCTION

THE CORP MEMBER THEY WANTED TO RETAIN

SCREENPLAY

SCENE 1 — 2 MINUTES

EXT. COMPANY GATE – MORNING

7:45 A.M.

Employees walk through the company gate.

SAMUEL, mid-20s, neatly dressed in his NYSC khaki trousers and a simple shirt, approaches the gate. He checks his phone.

7:48 A.M.

He takes a breath and walks in.

A few minutes later, DANIEL, also in NYSC uniform, approaches casually. He checks his phone.

DANIEL
This place sef.

He walks in.

INT. RECEPTION – CONTINUOUS

Samuel greets the SECURITY OFFICER.

SAMUEL
Good morning, sir.

SECURITY OFFICER
Morning, corps member.

Samuel smiles and continues inside.

Daniel walks in.

SECURITY OFFICER
Morning.

DANIEL
Morning, oga.

Daniel enters and sees Samuel already at his desk.

DANIEL
Guy, you don dey here since?

SAMUEL
Almost thirty minutes ago.

Daniel laughs.

DANIEL
You wan use NYSC win employee of the month?

Samuel smiles.

SAMUEL
Abeg, make I settle first.

Daniel drops his bag.

SCENE 2 — 2 MINUTES

INT. OFFICE – NEXT MORNING

7:55 A.M.

Samuel is arranging files at his desk.

MRS. GRACE, the HR Manager, walks in.

MRS. GRACE
Good morning, Samuel.

SAMUEL
Good morning, ma.

MRS. GRACE
You're early again.

SAMUEL
Yes, ma. I stay around here, so I try to leave early.

Mrs. Grace smiles.

The door opens.

8:16 A.M.

Daniel walks in.

DANIEL
Good morning, ma.

Mrs. Grace checks the clock.

MRS. GRACE
You're just coming?

DANIEL
Yes, ma. Traffic was serious this morning.

MRS. GRACE
Alright. Try to be here earlier tomorrow.

DANIEL
Yes, ma.

She walks away.

Daniel drops his bag.

DANIEL
Guy, this place is too serious.

SAMUEL
We're supposed to resume by eight.

DANIEL
Abeg. Na NYSC we dey do. It's not like we're permanent staff.

Samuel continues working.

SAMUEL
Still, we're here to work.

DANIEL
You and this your seriousness.

SCENE 3 — 3 MINUTES

INT. OFFICE – LATER THAT MORNING

MR. ADEYEMI, the Operations Manager, enters with a file.

MR. ADEYEMI
Samuel.

SAMUEL
Sir?

He hands Samuel the file.

MR. ADEYEMI
Arrange these documents according to department and date. I need them before lunch.

SAMUEL
Yes, sir.

Mr. Adeyemi turns to Daniel, who is on his phone.

MR. ADEYEMI
Daniel.

Daniel quickly puts the phone down.

DANIEL
Sir?

MR. ADEYEMI
Please assist Chidi with the client database.

DANIEL
The database, sir?

MR. ADEYEMI
Yes.

DANIEL
Sir, I thought I was handling the social media aspect.

MR. ADEYEMI
You are. Chidi needs assistance today.

Daniel hesitates.

DANIEL
Okay, sir.

Mr. Adeyemi leaves.

Daniel looks at Samuel.

DANIEL
You see? They will just keep giving us work.

SAMUEL
Na work we come do.

DANIEL
Until they give you the work of five people.

Samuel chuckles.

SAMUEL
Just do the one they gave you.

DANIEL
You're already sounding like management.

SCENE 4 — 2 MINUTES

INT. OFFICE – AFTERNOON

Samuel is still working through the documents.

CHIDI, a permanent staff member, walks over.

CHIDI
Samuel, you're still on this?

SAMUEL
Yes. I'm almost done.

CHIDI
You can continue tomorrow.

SAMUEL
I'd rather finish it today.

Chidi nods approvingly.

Across the room, Daniel is scrolling through his phone.

Mr. Adeyemi walks past.

MR. ADEYEMI
Daniel, how far with the database?

Daniel opens his laptop.

DANIEL
I'm working on it, sir.

Mr. Adeyemi looks at the screen.

Nothing has been done.

A brief silence.

MR. ADEYEMI
You've not started.

Daniel looks uncomfortable.

DANIEL
I was about to start, sir.

MR. ADEYEMI
Please do.

He walks away.

Samuel glances at Daniel but says nothing.

SCENE 5 — 3 MINUTES

INT. OFFICE – ONE WEEK LATER – MORNING

8:05 A.M.

Samuel is already at his desk.

Daniel walks in.

DANIEL
Morning.

SAMUEL
Morning.

DANIEL
Anything happen?

SAMUEL
Mr. Adeyemi asked for the weekly report.

DANIEL
Which report?

SAMUEL
The weekly report. He mentioned it yesterday.

DANIEL
I wasn't around.

Samuel looks at him.

SAMUEL
You left before closing.

Mr. Adeyemi approaches.

MR. ADEYEMI
Daniel, where is the report?

Daniel freezes.

DANIEL
Sir... I'm working on it.

MR. ADEYEMI
It was supposed to be submitted this morning.

DANIEL
Yes, sir.

MR. ADEYEMI
I need it before eleven.

DANIEL
Okay, sir.

Mr. Adeyemi walks away.

Daniel turns to Samuel.

DANIEL
Guy, abeg. You fit help me check the figures?

Samuel looks at him.

SAMUEL
I'll help you check it. But you have to do the report.

Daniel nods.

DANIEL
Fair enough.

For the first time, Daniel looks genuinely uncomfortable with his attitude.

SCENE 6 — 4 MINUTES

INT. MANAGER'S OFFICE – DAY

Mr. Adeyemi sits with Mrs. Grace. A file containing the corps members' records lies on the table.

MRS. GRACE
How are the corps members doing?

MR. ADEYEMI
Samuel is doing well.

MRS. GRACE
And Daniel?

MR. ADEYEMI
Daniel is intelligent. That's not the problem.

MRS. GRACE
Then what's the problem?

MR. ADEYEMI
Attitude.

Mrs. Grace nods.

MR. ADEYEMI
He does what you tell him. But nothing beyond that.

MRS. GRACE
Do you think he knows we're observing them?

Mr. Adeyemi smiles.

MR. ADEYEMI
No.

Mrs. Grace closes the file.

MRS. GRACE
Maybe that's the point.

Mr. Adeyemi looks at her.

MRS. GRACE
Sometimes people show you who they are when they think nobody is watching.

A beat.

INT. OFFICE – LATER

Mr. Adeyemi addresses Samuel and Daniel.

MR. ADEYEMI
We're preparing a presentation for an important client next week. I want both of you to assist.

He places the documents on the table.

MR. ADEYEMI
Deadline is Friday. Don't wait until Friday before asking questions.

Samuel takes out his notebook.

SAMUEL
Yes, sir.

DANIEL
Okay, sir.

Mr. Adeyemi leaves.

Daniel looks at Samuel writing.

DANIEL
Guy, you're writing notes for everything?

SAMUEL
I don't want to forget anything.

DANIEL
Relax. It's just presentation.

SAMUEL
It's important to them.

Daniel shakes his head.

DANIEL
You take everything too seriously.

Samuel smiles slightly.

SAMUEL
Maybe.

SCENE 7 — 4 MINUTES

INT. OFFICE – FRIDAY MORNING

The office is busy.

Samuel arrives early and places his completed section on the table.

Daniel walks in later.

DANIEL
Morning.

SAMUEL
Morning.

DANIEL
You've done your part?

SAMUEL
Yes.

Daniel opens his laptop.

DANIEL
I'll do mine now.

Samuel looks at him.

SAMUEL
Now?

DANIEL
I work better under pressure.

Samuel says nothing.

INT. CONFERENCE ROOM – LATER

Mr. Adeyemi sits with other staff members.

The presentation is displayed on a screen.

Samuel's section is complete and well organised.

Daniel's section is incomplete.

Mr. Adeyemi looks at him.

MR. ADEYEMI
Daniel, what happened here?

DANIEL
Sir, I was going to complete it.

MR. ADEYEMI
The presentation starts in thirty minutes.

Daniel looks down.

MR. ADEYEMI
Why wasn't this done earlier?

Daniel has no answer.

A beat.

MR. ADEYEMI
Samuel, can you help him complete the section?

SAMUEL
Yes, sir.

Daniel looks at Samuel.

INT. OFFICE – EVENING

The office is almost empty.

Samuel and Daniel pack their bags.

Daniel pauses.

DANIEL
Samuel.

SAMUEL
Yes?

DANIEL
Why do you always do more than they ask?

Samuel thinks.

SAMUEL
I just want to learn.

DANIEL
But after NYSC, everybody will still move on.

SAMUEL
That's true.

DANIEL
So what's the point?

Samuel looks at him.

SAMUEL
We're here now.

Daniel smiles.

DANIEL
You really think this company will employ you because you're hardworking?

SAMUEL
I don't know.

A pause.

SAMUEL
But if they give me an opportunity, I want them to know they can trust me.

Daniel looks at him.

For once, he has nothing to say.

SCENE 8 — 2 MINUTES

INT. OFFICE – THREE MONTHS LATER – MORNING

Three months have passed.

Samuel assists Chidi with a project. The staff now comfortably rely on him.

Daniel sits at his desk.

Mr. Adeyemi approaches.

MR. ADEYEMI
Daniel, please send this email to the client.

Daniel takes the document.

DANIEL
Sir, is that part of my responsibility?

Mr. Adeyemi pauses.

MR. ADEYEMI
No.

Daniel looks up.

MR. ADEYEMI
I asked you to help.

A beat.

DANIEL
Okay, sir.

He takes the document.

Mr. Adeyemi walks away.

Daniel looks across the office at Samuel helping Chidi.

He watches quietly.

SCENE 9 — 2 MINUTES

INT. OFFICE – ONE WEEK BEFORE PASSING-OUT

Mrs. Grace addresses the corps members.

MRS. GRACE
Your service year is almost over.

Daniel smiles.

DANIEL
Finally.

Everyone laughs.

MRS. GRACE
Don't celebrate yet. You still have clearance and your final reports.

DANIEL
Yes, ma.

LATER

Samuel and Daniel stand near the office entrance.

DANIEL
So, what are you doing after NYSC?

SAMUEL
I'm applying for jobs.

DANIEL
Same here.

Daniel looks around the office.

DANIEL
This company sef... I think they like us.

Samuel smiles.

SAMUEL
Maybe.

DANIEL
If they have opening, I wouldn't mind staying.

SAMUEL
Then let them know.

Daniel nods confidently.

DANIEL
They'll know.

SCENE 10 — 4 MINUTES

INT. HR OFFICE – FINAL DAY

Daniel sits opposite Mrs. Grace.

She hands him his clearance letter.

MRS. GRACE
Here is your clearance letter.

DANIEL
Thank you, ma.

He stands but hesitates.

DANIEL
Ma...

MRS. GRACE
Yes?

DANIEL
Before I go... is there any possibility of staying back?

Mrs. Grace looks at him.

DANIEL
If there's any opening, I'd really like to continue here.

Mrs. Grace gives him a polite smile.

MRS. GRACE
At the moment, there isn't an available position for you.

Daniel nods slowly.

DANIEL
Okay, ma. I understand.

MRS. GRACE
All the best, Daniel.

DANIEL
Thank you, ma.

He leaves.

INT. MANAGER'S OFFICE – SAME DAY

Samuel sits opposite Mr. Adeyemi.

MR. ADEYEMI
Samuel, your service year is officially over.

SAMUEL
Yes, sir.

MR. ADEYEMI
You've done well.

Samuel smiles.

SAMUEL
Thank you, sir.

Mr. Adeyemi slides an envelope across the table.

Samuel opens it.

His eyes widen.

SAMUEL
Sir... what's this?

MR. ADEYEMI
An employment offer.

Samuel looks up, surprised.

SAMUEL
Sir?

MR. ADEYEMI
We've been watching your work since you resumed.

Samuel is speechless.

MR. ADEYEMI
You came here as a corps member. But you behaved like someone who wanted to build a career.

Samuel smiles, genuinely emotional.

SAMUEL
Thank you very much, sir.

MR. ADEYEMI
You earned it.

Samuel nods.

EXT. COMPANY GATE – EVENING

Daniel walks out of the company carrying his bag and NYSC documents.

He stops at the gate.

He turns and looks back at the building.

Samuel walks out behind him.

SAMUEL
Daniel.

Daniel turns.

DANIEL
Oh, Samuel.

They shake hands.

DANIEL
Congratulations, man.

SAMUEL
Thank you.

Daniel notices the document in Samuel's hand.

DANIEL
So it's true?

Samuel nods.

SAMUEL
Yes.

Daniel smiles, but disappointment is visible in his eyes.

DANIEL
Good for you.

A pause.

Daniel looks back at the company.

DANIEL
You know something?

SAMUEL
What?

DANIEL
I actually thought they would retain me.

Samuel looks at him.

SAMUEL
Why?

Daniel gives a small laugh.

DANIEL
I don't know. I just thought... maybe.

Silence.

Daniel looks at the company one more time.

DANIEL
I guess I didn't take the place seriously enough.

Samuel nods.

SAMUEL
Sometimes, we don't know which opportunity is bigger than it looks.

Daniel looks at him.

The words sink in.

DANIEL
You're right.

A beat.

They shake hands again.

DANIEL
Take care, bro.

SAMUEL
You too.

Daniel walks away.

Samuel watches him for a moment.

Then he turns toward the company and walks inside.

FADE OUT.

THE END